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Request for Proposals 2026-31-P — Information Technology Partner Services

Issued by: Sanderling Coast Workers' Compensation Board

Issue date: 15 June 2026

Closing date and time: 20 July 2026 at 2:00 p.m. local time

Term: Three years from the date of award, with two optional extensions of one year each, exercisable by the Board at its sole discretion.

All enquiries respecting this Request for Proposals must be submitted in writing to the procurement contact identified below. No other representative of the Board is authorised to interpret this RFP, and no oral statement by any person binds the Board. Answers to enquiries of general application will be issued by written addendum to all registered Applicants.

Procurement contact:

Procurement Lead, Corporate Services Division Sanderling Coast Workers' Compensation Board Purchasing and Contracts, Level 4 18 Saltmeadow Row Saltmeadow, Sanderling Coast

Section 1: Introduction and Background

The Sanderling Coast Workers' Compensation Board is a statutory corporation responsible for administering the province's workers' compensation system. The Board registers employers, sets and collects assessments on insurable payroll, adjudicates claims for workplace injury and occupational disease, pays wage-loss and medical benefits, and administers return-to-work programmes. It is funded entirely by employer assessments and holds an accident fund on behalf of the system rather than drawing on general revenue. Approximately 19,000 registered employers and an insured workforce of some 148,000 persons fall within its coverage, and the Board registers in the order of 6,800 new claims each year.

The Board's obligations are statutory, time-bound and audited. Assessment notices must issue on a legislated cycle, benefit calculations must reflect the rate schedule in force on the date of injury, and the Board must report annually to the province on the funded position of the accident fund. Technology failure is therefore not a matter of inconvenience: an interruption to the claims system suspends adjudication and payment, and a defect in the assessment portal is visible to the whole employer base within a single filing period.

The Board employs a small internal technology group responsible for architecture, standards, operations and the integrity of the estate. That group does not have, and does not intend to build, the capacity to absorb the peaks created by legislative amendment, portal releases, integration work and the annual assessment cycle. Demand is uneven across a fiscal year and uneven across skill sets, and the Board has determined that this demand is better met through a single partner engaged under one agreement than through repeated competitions for individual work packages.

The Board accordingly seeks proposals from qualified Applicants to act as its information technology partner for a term of three years, with two optional one-year extensions. The resulting agreement will be a framework under which work is authorised by individual written work order. The Board makes no representation as to the volume, value or continuity of work to be ordered, guarantees no minimum, and reserves the right to procure any particular requirement separately where it considers that course to be in the interest of the system.

Section 2: Proposal Instructions

Proposals must be received no later than the closing date and time stated on the first page of this RFP. The Board's electronic tendering portal is the only accepted channel of submission; proposals delivered by any other means, and proposals received after the closing time as recorded by that portal, will be rejected without being opened or read.

Each proposal must be submitted as a single searchable PDF document, bearing sequential page numbers and a table of contents, and must be legible when printed at actual size. Applicants must present their response in the order of the Required Content items listed in Section 4 and must label each part with the corresponding item name, so that the evaluation committee can locate every element of the response without inference. Cross-references in place of a response are not acceptable, except within the Applicant's own proposal where the same material answers two items.

The proposal must be signed by an officer authorised to bind the Applicant, must acknowledge every addendum issued by the Board to the closing date, and must remain open for acceptance for 120 days from the closing date.

A proposal that omits a Required Content item, or that fails to supply detail sufficient to permit the evaluation committee to assess it against the criteria in Section 5, may be found non-compliant and given no further consideration. The Board may, but is not obliged to, seek clarification of a submitted proposal; a request for clarification does not entitle an Applicant to supplement or amend its proposal. The Board is not liable for any cost of preparing or presenting a proposal.

Section 3: Scope of Services

The successful Applicant will provide information technology professional services across the Board's application portfolio. That portfolio comprises six systems:

- the **Claims Administration System**, the system of record for registration, adjudication, benefit calculation, payment and appeal;
- the **Employer Assessment Portal**, through which registered employers file payroll declarations, receive assessment notices and remit premiums;
- the **Return-to-Work Case Management** workload, used by case managers, treating practitioners and employers to coordinate recovery plans;
- the **Prevention and Compliance Registry**, which records workplace inspections, orders and employer compliance history;
- the **Benefit Disbursement Ledger**, which effects payments to workers, providers and third parties and reconciles them to the accident fund; and
- the **Corporate Reporting Warehouse**, which supports statutory, actuarial and operational reporting.

Services will be ordered in the following categories.

3.1 Application development and integration. Design, construction, modification and remediation of functionality within the six systems, and construction and maintenance of the interfaces between them and to external parties, including financial institutions, health care providers and the province's records repositories. Work on the Claims Administration System must accommodate benefit rules that change by legislative amendment while keeping

historical claim data reconcilable across rule versions.

3.2 Project delivery. Management and delivery of discrete projects for which the Board sets the outcome and the successful Applicant assumes accountability for plan, resourcing, quality, schedule and cost. Projects must be delivered under a defined, gated method with documented entry and exit criteria at each stage, and must report through the Board's own governance forums.

3.3 Business analysis. Elicitation and documentation of requirements, process mapping, options analysis, authoring of user stories and definition of acceptance criteria, in the Board's formats and repositories. Analysts must be capable of working directly with adjudicators, assessment officers and case managers, and of tracing every requirement to the statutory or operational obligation it serves.

3.4 Testing. Preparation and execution of test plans and test cases at unit, integration, regression and acceptance stages, including regression testing of benefit calculation against the rate schedules in force for prior periods, and load testing of the Employer Assessment Portal against peak filing-period volumes.

3.5 Staff augmentation. Provision of named individuals to work within Board-led teams for defined periods, under the direction of the Board's own leads and to the Board's standards and tooling. The Applicant remains the employer of record and is responsible for continuity, replacement and all associated administration.

3.6 Service desk and issue escalation. The Applicant must operate a service desk through which Board staff report defects, incidents and service requests arising from work performed under the agreement, and must maintain an issue escalation model that governs how an unresolved matter is raised and to whom. The Applicant is required to describe both. The description must identify the single point of contact accountable to the Board, the hours during which the service desk is attended and the arrangements in force outside those hours, the severity or priority scheme by which reported issues are classified, the acknowledgement and resolution target applying to each class, the tiers through which an issue escalates and the elapsed time that triggers each escalation, and the procedure invoked for a major incident, including notification of the Board and post-incident reporting. Coverage must extend to the assessment filing periods and to scheduled cutover windows, which fall outside ordinary business hours.

Section 4: Response Requirements

Applicants must address each item below, in the order given, using the item name as the heading of the corresponding part of the proposal.

Required Content	Instruction
Response Format	The Applicant must present its proposal in the order of this table, using these item names as headings, in a single searchable PDF with sequential page numbering. A response that reorganises or consolidates these items may be found non-compliant under Section 2.
Cover Letter	The Applicant must provide a covering letter of no more than two pages, signed by an officer authorised to bind the Applicant. It must confirm that no exception is taken to any mandatory requirement, acknowledge every addendum issued, and state that the proposal remains open for acceptance for 120 days.

Table of Contents	The Applicant must include a table of contents listing every Required Content item and the page on which the response to it begins.
Company Profile & Services	The Applicant must identify the legal entity that would hold the resulting agreement, its ownership and its place of incorporation, and describe the range of technology services it offers.
Conflict of Interest	The Applicant must disclose any actual, potential or perceived conflict of interest affecting itself, a subcontractor or a proposed individual, including any part taken in preparing this RFP and any interest in another proposal. A disclosed conflict must be accompanied by proposed mitigation for the Board's written approval; failure to disclose is grounds for disqualification at any time.
Privacy/Confidentiality	The Applicant must state how Board information, including the personal and health information of injured workers, is safeguarded, restricted to personnel who require it, and returned or destroyed at the end of the agreement. The Applicant must identify the privacy legislation with which it undertakes to comply and confirm that every assigned individual is bound by a written confidentiality undertaking and a code of business conduct.
Overview	The Applicant must demonstrate its understanding of the Board's mandate and statutory obligations, of the services required under Section 3 and how the mix among them may vary over the term, and of the division of responsibility it expects between the Board and itself. General statements about the sector will not be credited.
Approach and Methodology	The Applicant must describe, separately for each, the methodologies it would apply to development, integration, project management, quality assurance, risk management, change management, governance and performance reporting, and issue escalation and service desk operation, including the model required by Section 3.6. For each methodology the Applicant must state the controls that are mandatory in its practice and the evidence a Board representative could inspect to confirm they were applied.
Professional Staff Complement	The Applicant must identify by role each individual proposed for the core complement, state that individual's availability from the commencement date, and describe the controls governing substitution.
Professional Staff Résumés	The Applicant must provide a résumé for each proposed individual, in a consistent format not exceeding three pages, stating education, credentials, years of relevant experience and the engagements on which it was obtained. Generic or role-based résumés will not be accepted.

Value-added Service	The Applicant must identify any service, capability, tool or commitment it would provide at no additional cost, and state the basis on which it is offered and any condition attaching to it. The Board will not credit an offer whose value it cannot verify from the proposal.
Geographic Location	The Applicant must identify the location from which each element of the services would be delivered, state the on-site attendance it commits to at the Board's premises, and state under whose direction any element delivered remotely is performed and how it accesses Board environments.
Previous Experience	The Applicant must describe not fewer than three engagements of comparable size, scope and complexity from the last five years, stating for each the client type, the services provided, the duration and the final value. At least one must have involved a system of record subject to legislated calculation rules.
References	The Applicant must provide three references from the engagements described, identified by role and organisation, and must confirm that each referee has consented to be approached during evaluation. The Board will not accept personal contact details in the body of the proposal.
Timelines, Schedules and Fees	The Applicant must describe how timelines and milestone schedules are established, baselined and reported for work ordered under the agreement, and must complete the rate schedule at Appendix A in full. A rate schedule that is incomplete, qualified or conditional may be found non-compliant.

Section 5: Evaluation Criteria

Compliant proposals will be scored against the criteria and weights below.

Criterion	Weight
Quality of proposal and demonstrated understanding of RFP requirements	10%
Organization experience	10%
Applicant's Technical Solution	35%
Fees	45%

Section 6: Mandatory Criteria

The following criteria are mandatory. Each is assessed on a pass or fail basis before a proposal is scored under Section 5, and a proposal that fails any one of them will be given no further consideration. The Board will not waive a mandatory criterion.

M1. Each individual proposed in a senior role — project manager, senior systems analyst, lead developer, solution architect or quality assurance lead — must hold a bachelor's degree in computer science, engineering, information systems or a related discipline, and must have not fewer than ten years of relevant professional experience. The degree and the years must be evidenced in the résumé required by Section 4.

M2. The Applicant must warrant in its cover letter that no individual assigned to work under the agreement, whether proposed in its complement or supplied later, will have fewer than three years of relevant professional experience in the role assigned.

M3. The Applicant must state, in a discrete part of its proposal, every objection it takes to the draft terms and conditions issued with this RFP, identifying each objection by clause and stating the alternative sought. An Applicant that states no objection is taken to have accepted the draft terms in full. No objection raised after the closing date will be entertained.

Appendix A: Pricing Schedule

Fees are to be submitted on the rate schedule accompanying this RFP. The schedule requires an all-inclusive hourly rate for each role in the Applicant's proposed complement and for each additional role the Applicant offers, stated in Canadian dollars, exclusive of applicable taxes and inclusive of all overhead, administration, tooling, insurance and travel within the province. Rates must be firm for the initial three-year term; the Applicant must state the basis on which any adjustment would be sought for an extension year. Rates submitted are used to compute the Fees score under Section 5.

Out of scope for this exercise. The rate schedule is not reproduced or populated in this synthetic corpus, and no rate, unit price or contract value appears in it.